



MyBCIT UI/UX Re- design: UX Case Study

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I: Summary

MyBCIT is the main student portal for the British Columbia Institute of Technology, a school well known for its fast-paced, hands-on learning environment and strong reputation across BC.

Despite BCIT's commitment to modern education, the MyBCIT platform has been receiving a lot of negative feedback from students for its outdated interface, confusing layout, and overall difficulty in navigating.

Through user research, iterative prototyping, and usability testing with over ten participants, this project proposes a full redesign of MyBCIT that reduces navigation complexity, improves accessibility, and modernizes the visual system while staying true to BCIT's established brand identity.

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2: USER RESEARCH

WHOM I INTERVIEWED:

I interviewed three groups of people: students currently enrolled at BCIT, graduates who were already familiar with the platform, and a few people who had never used MyBCIT before.

Including people with no experience was important because it gave me a clearer picture of how approachable the interface actually is to someone seeing it for the first time.

HOW PEOPLE THINK ABOUT MYBCIT:

Before jumping into interviews, I also did some secondary research online and found that people on the BCIT subreddit were actively complaining about the platform. Seeing how many people shared the same frustrations helped me understand just how widespread the problem was, and it shaped the direction of my questions.

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2: USER RESEARCH

QUESTIONS I ASKED:

During my interviews, I asked each person the following questions to get a better sense of how they used MyBCIT and what was and was not working for them:

- Are you familiar with MyBCIT, and how often do you use it?
- Which features do you actually use, and which ones do you tend to avoid?
- How would you rate MyBCIT in terms of how easy it is to use?
- What are the biggest frustrations you have when using it?
- How long does it usually take you to find your grades?
- Would something like an AI support assistant make the experience better for you?

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2: USER RESEARCH

The majority of people I spoke with had similar things to say, and most of it was not great. The most common complaints I heard were:

- There are way too many steps just to get to basic pages like grades, with participants reporting an average of six or more clicks to reach their academic information
- Important information is buried under tabs and sections that are not relevant to students
- The platform has a steep learning curve and is not welcoming to new students at all
- The visual design feels inconsistent and well behind the standards of modern websites
- Getting support through email takes far too long and feels outdated as a system

These findings directly shaped the redesign priorities. The core goal became reducing the number of steps to reach key information, bringing the most important content forward, and refreshing the visual design while keeping it recognizably BCIT.

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3: TIMELINE

FOLDER 04

A

Concept was made

B

Started sketching and
researching

C

low-fidelity made

D

Worked on Hi-Fi part I

E

Worked on Hi-Fi part 2

F

Created UX Case Study

G

Finalize project and
created slides on Figma

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4: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOR

DESIGN PROCESS

Redesigning MyBCIT came with its own set of challenges. The biggest one was figuring out how to modernize the interface without losing the identity BCIT already has. Their colours are blue, yellow, and white, and I wanted to work within that rather than against it.

Accessibility was also a key consideration throughout the process. Feedback from user testing highlighted that larger text and stronger colour contrast made the platform significantly more usable, particularly for students with visual difficulties. These were not afterthoughts but deliberate decisions made early in the design process to ensure the redesign worked for as wide a range of users as possible.

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4: DESIGN PROCESS & COLOR

DESIGN PROCESS

The process involved brand research, sketching, building out low-fidelity wireframes, and then working through multiple rounds of high-fidelity prototyping in Figma. Every decision was connected back to what I heard during the research phase, which made it easier to justify the changes I was proposing.

COLOR PALETTE:

0A345E

Main Color

FDEB5B

Secondary Color

ffffff

Background Color

000000

Fonts/Letters

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5: USER TESTING RESULTS

I tested the prototype with over ten people, including current students, graduates, and users who had never seen MyBCIT before. Each person was asked to work through key tasks like finding their grades and navigating to student services, so I could observe where things felt smooth and where people got stuck.

Here are a few things people had to say:

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5: USER TESTING RESULTS

Emme W.

“I like how everything goes together well, especially the chatting options instead of email. If I had to say one thing I don’t like is the green that was used for the online status.”

From the same program

Courtney Y.

“It looks good but I would want the message sending as an option. It’s making me want to click on everything, which is nice.”

From the same program

Kristian T.

“I love the buttons and how clear it is. It definitely looks more like a BCIT page now. I am more willing to use it if the interface looks like this.”

BCIT Graphic Design Program

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5: USER TESTING RESULTS

A BCIT Graduate

“It is cleaner and definitely an upgrade from the old one. It was too outdated and ugly.”

Do not know their program

BACK

A BCIT Graduate

“It definitely looks a lot more simple and I love how big the texts are. Super helpful for those who has reading problems and I like how there is the personalized option.”

Do not know their program

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6: SUMMARY

FOLDER 05

This project pushed me to look at a system I used every day and actually break down why it was so frustrating to use. Going through the full process, from research all the way to high fidelity prototyping and usability testing, gave me a much stronger understanding of how small design decisions can have a big impact on how people feel when they use a product.

Reducing the click depth to reach grades, improving text legibility, and consolidating navigation were all relatively small changes on the surface, but user testing showed they made a meaningful difference in how approachable and usable the platform felt. That taught me something important about UX design: the most impactful changes are not always the most visible ones.

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6: SUMMARY

FOLDER 05

I am really proud of how the redesign turned out. More importantly, every decision was backed by real feedback from real people, which made the whole process feel purposeful rather than just aesthetic.

The next steps would be running a second round of structured usability testing to validate the changes made based on initial feedback, tracking navigation patterns through heatmaps, and exploring what an integrated AI support feature could look like in practice while considering the responsibilities that come with designing a platform that handles sensitive student data.

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7: BEFORE VS AFTER

BEFORE

BCIT

Sign in

BCIT email

user@bcit.ca or user@my.bcit.ca

NEXT

[Forgot your BCIT email?](#)

The resource you've requested is restricted to BCIT students, staff or faculty only. Enter your BCIT email and password to continue.

Important

When finished your session, be sure to completely log out of all applications and close/quit all browsers. This will improve security and prevent others from using your access.

Need help?

If you are having trouble logging in, there may be an issue with your credentials (BCIT email and/or password). [Get help.](#)

By signing in, you agree to our [Acceptable Use and Security policies.](#)

Copyright

Privacy

BACK

AFTER

BCIT
BRITISH COLUMBIA
INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY

BOTH FIELDS VISIBLE,
REDUCED STEPS TO LOGIN

Email

example@my.bcit.ca

Password

enter...

Sign In

[Forgot password?](#)

Remember Me ☐

PERSONALISED
STUDENT PROFILE

Jimmy Ho

A12345678

Hide on Home Page ☐

Hide Status ☐

Student Self Services:

Update Personal Information

Check Grades

Program Status

View Tuition Fees

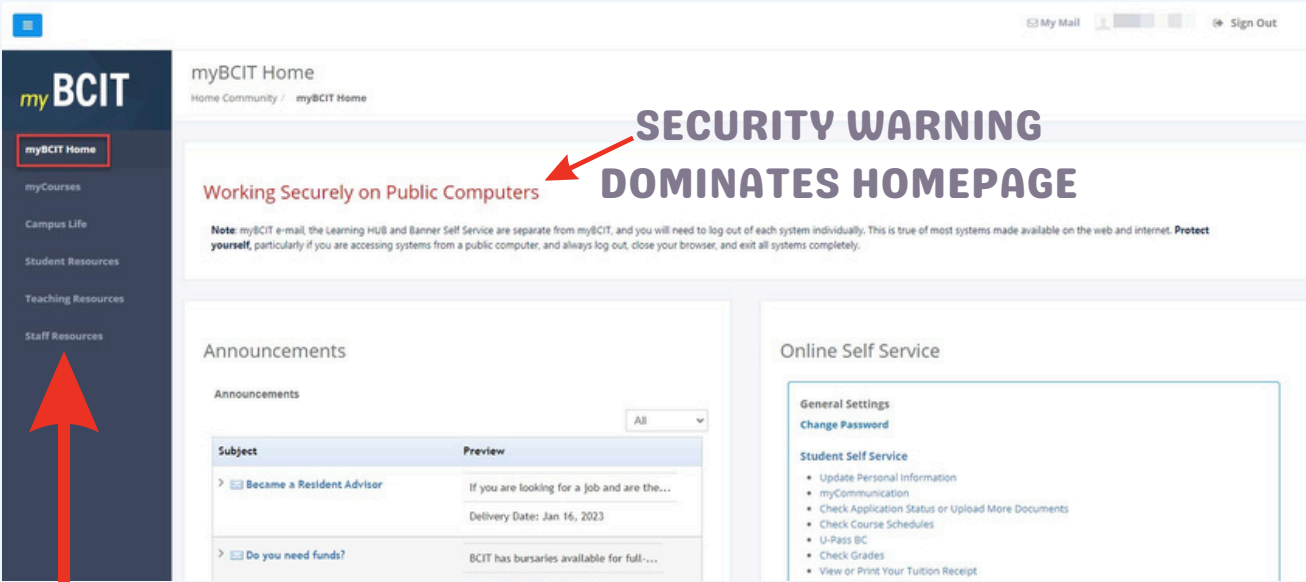
Order Official Transcripts

Log Out

NEXT

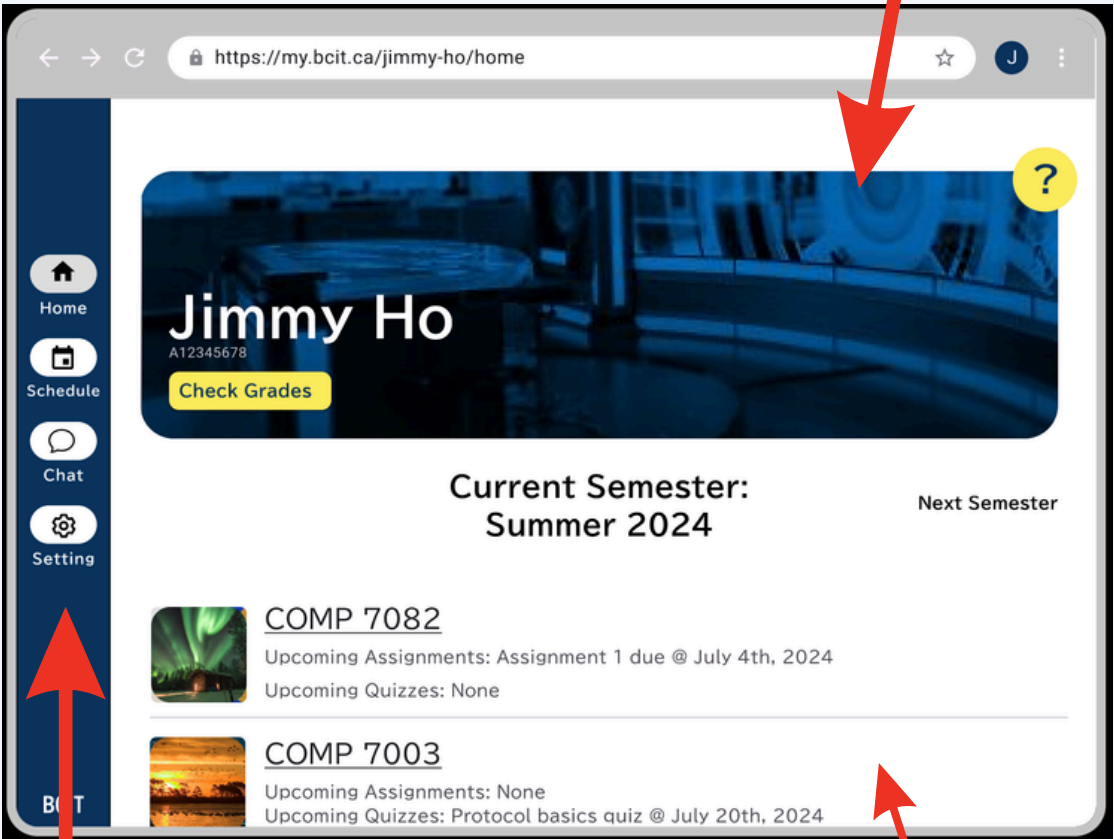
7: BEFORE VS AFTER

BEFORE



LINKS UNRELATED
TO STUDENTS

AFTER



PERSONALISED
BANNER

SIMPLIFIED MENU

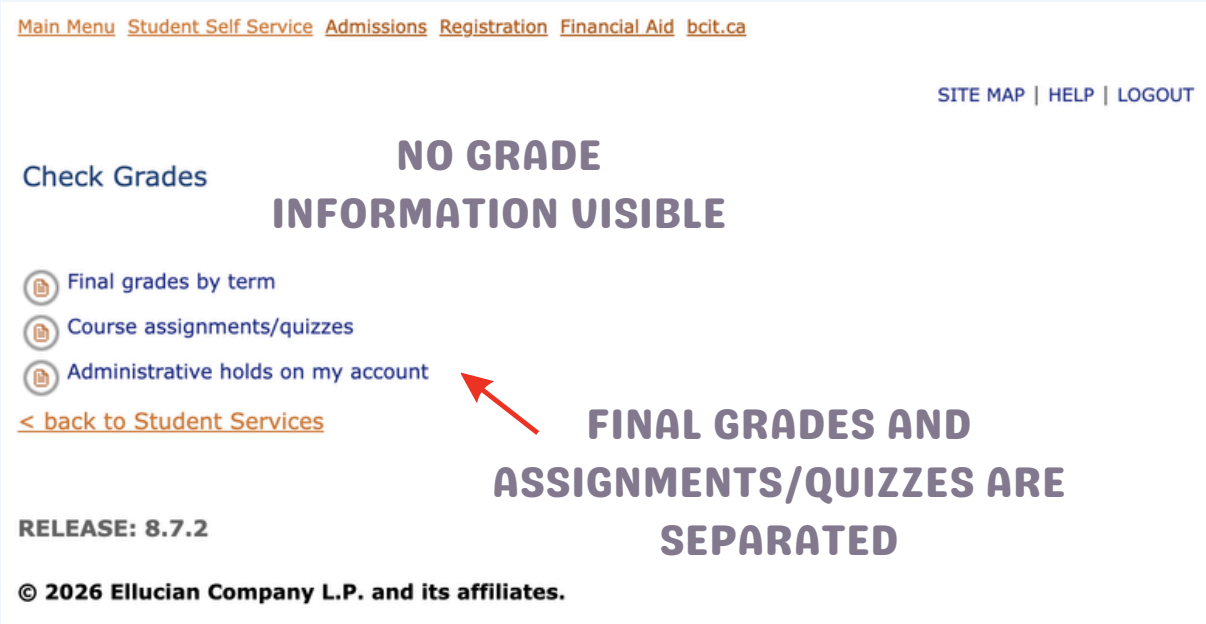
EASILY VIEWED
COURSE PLAN

BACK

NEXT

7: BEFORE VS AFTER

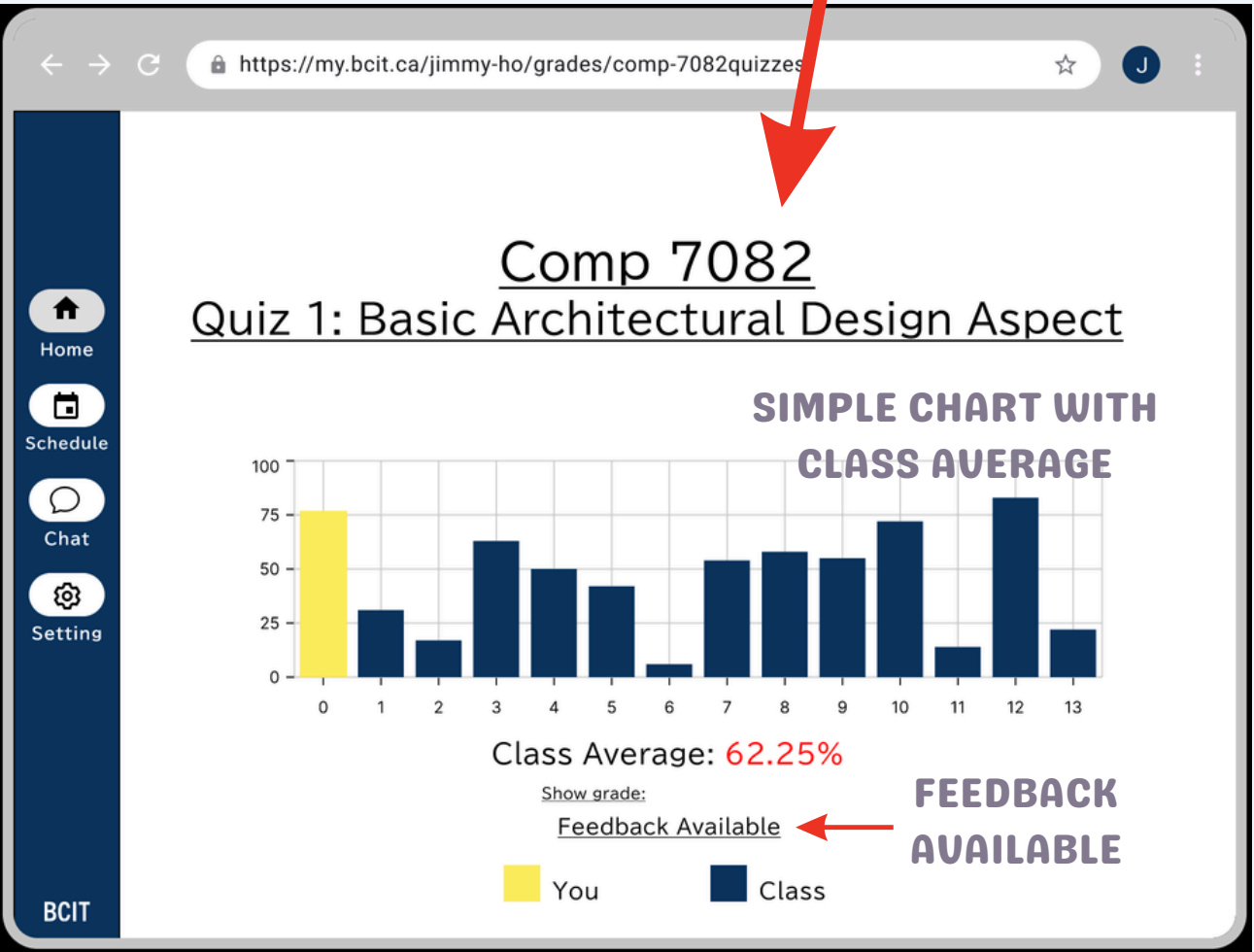
BEFORE



INTERFACE LAST UPDATED IN 2003 ERA DESIGN STANDARDS

BACK

AFTER



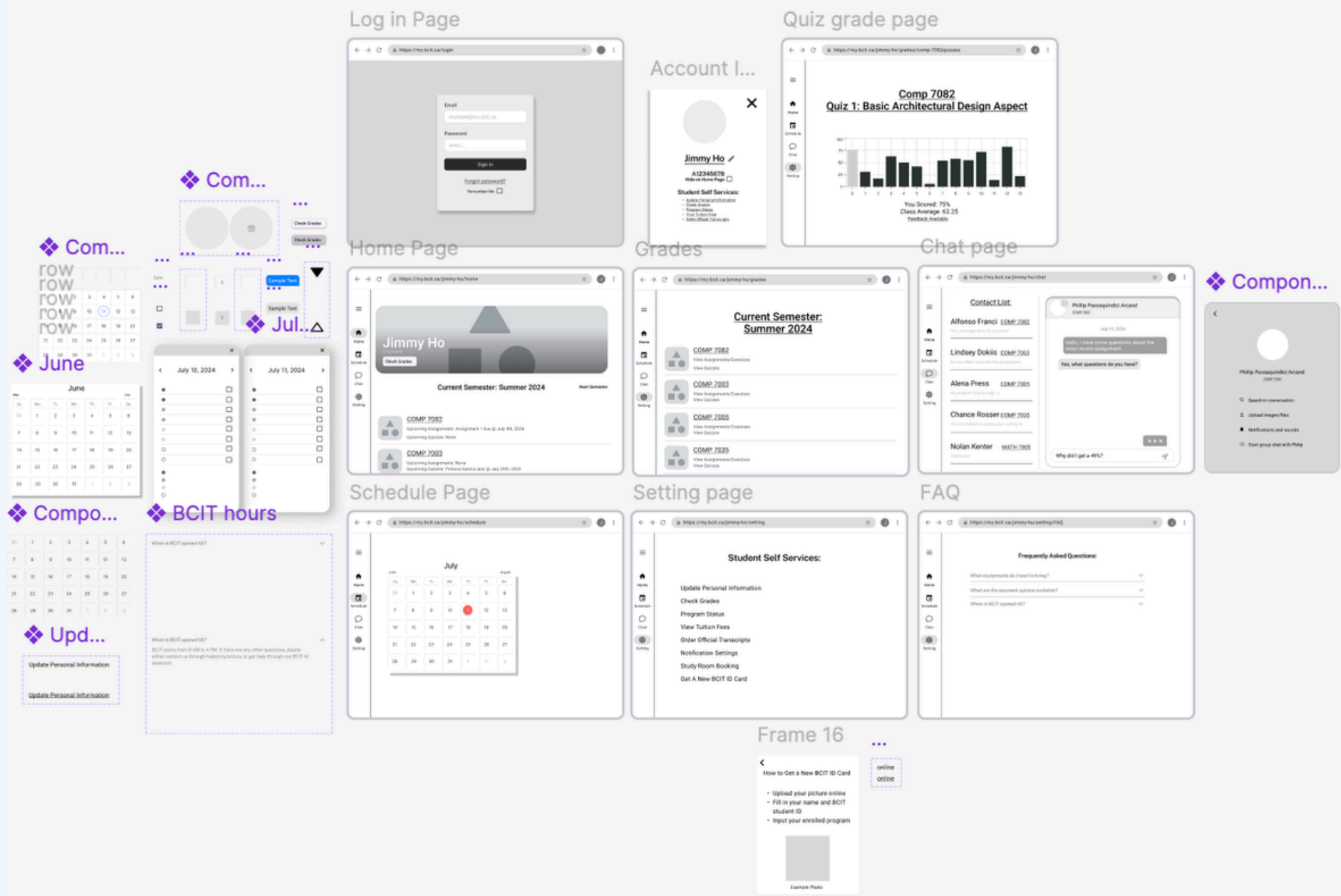
EYE-CATCHING COURSE AND QUIZ NAMES

FEEDBACK AVAILABLE

NEXT

8: SCREENSHOTS & LINK

LOW-FIDELITY

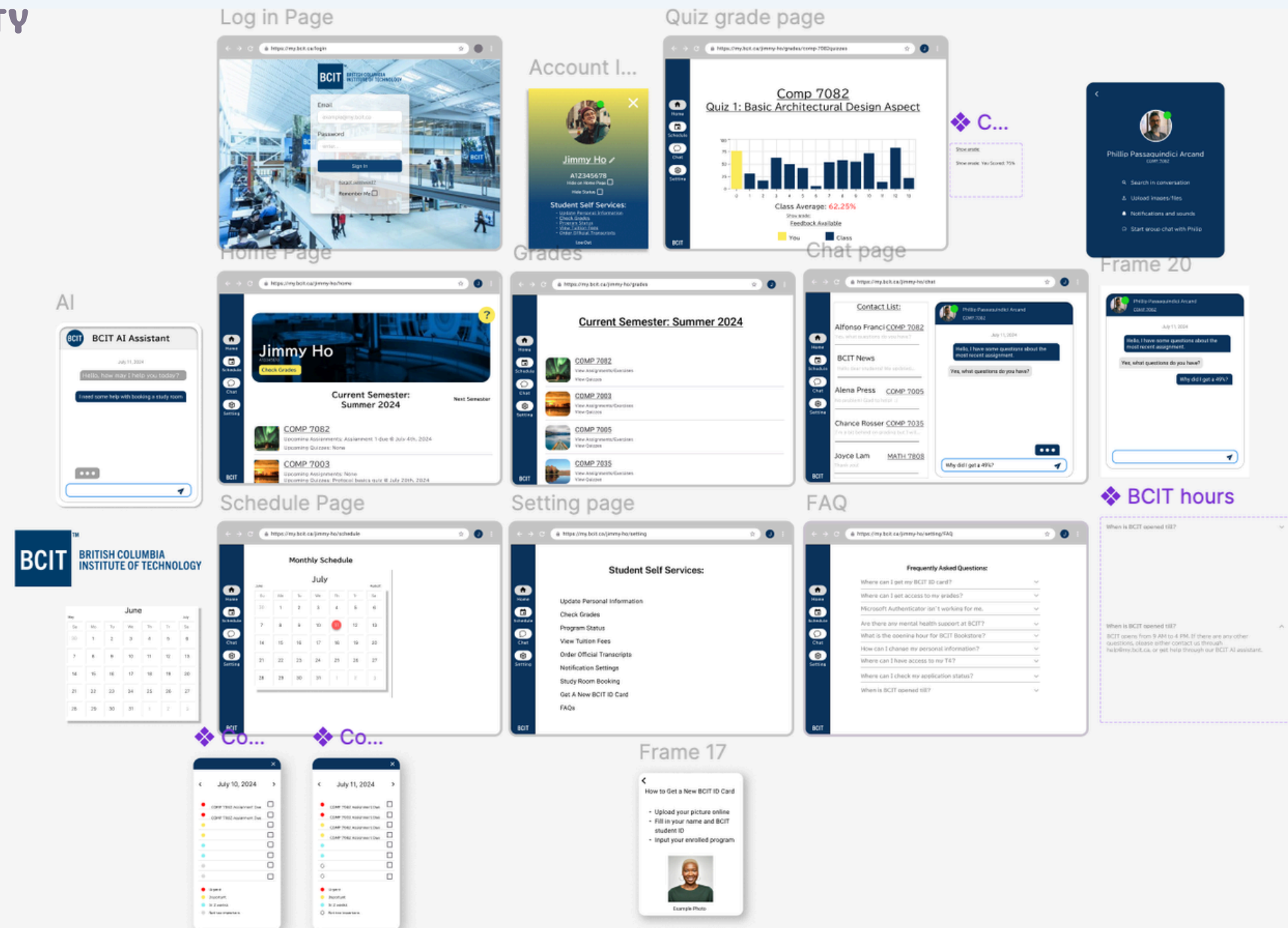


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NEXT

8: SCREENSHOTS & LINK

HIGH-FIDELITY



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NEXT

8: SCREENSHOTS & LINK

LINK TO FIGMA:

Figma Link:

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THANK YOU

by Sonya Yeh

